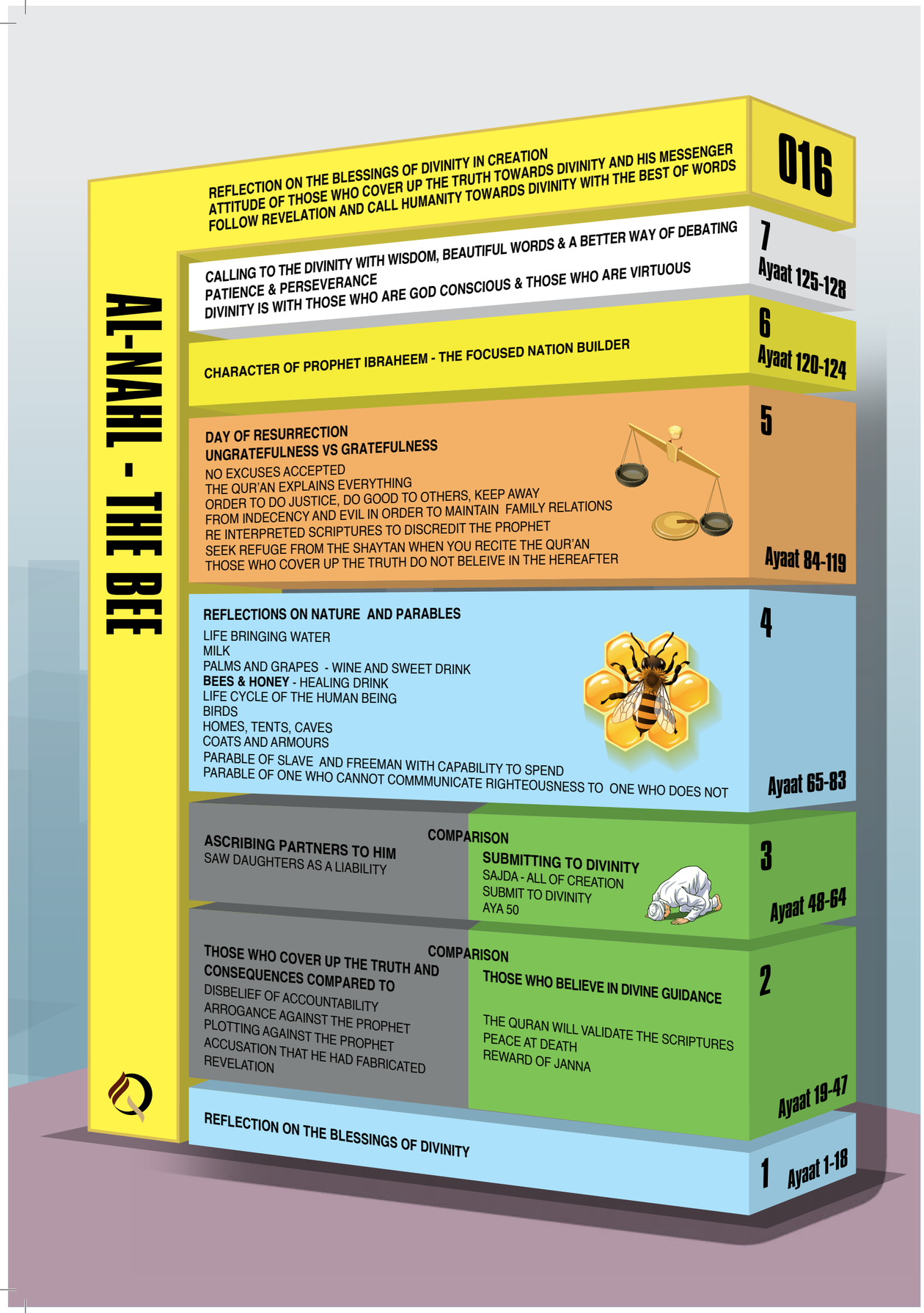

016. Al-Nahl ~ The Bee

128 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

REFLECTION ON THE BLESSINGS OF DIVINITY IN CREATION
ATTITUDE OF THOSE WHO COVER UP THE TRUTH TOWARDS DIVINITY AND HIS MESSENGER
FOLLOW REVELATION AND CALL HUMANITY TOWARDS DIVINITY WITH THE BEST OF WORDS

DID YOU KNOW?

THE CHAPTER IS ALSO KNOWN AS AL NIAAM - THE BLESSINGS BECAUSE OF THE MANY REFERENCES TO THE BLESSINGS GIVEN TO HUMAN BEINGS THROUGH THE WONDERS AND SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE OF NATURE.

SELECTED AYAAT

16:18	Not able to compute His favours
16:28	Answer of unjust when faced with death
16:32	Angels address to those who are righteous
16:50	Mustahab Sajda
16:68	Nahl (The bee)
16:78	Thankfulness
16:115	Rules for halal meat
16:125	Tableegh

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH THE SPECIFIC BLESSINGS DIVINITY HAS BLESSED HUMAN BEINGS WITH INCLUDING THE BENEFITS AND USES OF LIVESTOCK, WATER, CROPS, VEGETATION, THE SEA AND ITS BOUNTIES, CELESTIAL BODIES, MOUNTAINS, STREAM, STARS AND OTHER LANDMARKS THAT PROVIDE GUIDANCE FOR TRAVEL.

IT CONTINUES WITH THE DENIAL OF THOSE WHO COVERED UP THE TRUTH OF ACCOUNTABILITY AND THEIR ARROGANCE TOWARDS THE PROPHET ACCUSING HIM OF FABRICATING REVELATION. THERE IS REPEATED WARNINGS OF PUNISHMENT AS A CONSEQUNCE.
VERSES 48-52 FOCUS ON THE NATURE OF ALL CREATED BEINGS TO PROSTRATE TO DIVINITY WITH THE SHADOW PRESENTED AS A SYMBOLIC ILLUSTRATION THAT ALL CREATION ULTIMATELY SUBMITS TO ALLAH.

THE CHAPTER TRANSITONS INTO FURTHER REFLECTIONS ON NATURE SUCH AS WATER, MILK, DRINKS FROM PALM AND GRAPES, BEES & HONEY - THE HUMAN BEING, BIRDS….. AND PARABLES TO DISPLAY THE AWESOMENESS OF ALLAH FOLLOWED BY A COMPARSION OF THOSE WHO ARE GRATEFUL VERSUS THOSE WHO ARE UNGRATEFUL AND THE CONSEQUENCES ON THE DAY OF JUDGEMENT.

A FOCUS ON THE CHARACTER OF PROPHET IBRAHEEM AND AN EXHORTATION TO FOLLOW HIS CREED FOLLOWS.
THE CHAPTER CLOSES WITH INSTRUCTIONS OF HOW TO CALL HUMANITY TO DIVINITY WITH WISDOM, BEAUTIFUL WORDS, DEBATING WITH WHAT IS BETTER AND RESPONDING WITH PATIENCE AND RESTRAINT WHEN WRONGED.